Asparagus Inspection Manual

“Quality Control Service at Destination”

ASP-INS-MAN-DES

JULY – 2020

Tolerances

QC SCORE	Very Good	Good	Fair	Poor	Bad
	1	2	3	4	5
QUALITY DEFECTS	%	%	%	%	%
General Appearance	1	2	3	4	5
Undersize (Diameter)	0 - 15	> 15 - 30	> 30 - 50	> 50 - 75	>75
Oversize (Diameter)	0 - 15	> 15 - 30	> 30 - 50	> 50 - 75	>75
White Butts	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Broken Tips	0 - 10	> 10 - 25	> 25 - 50	> 50 - 75	> 75
Too Long Stalks	0 - 10	> 10 - 25	> 25 - 50	> 50 - 75	> 75
Too Short Stalks	0 - 10	> 10 - 25	> 25 - 50	> 50 - 75	> 75
Misshape	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Mechanical Damage	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Poor Trimming	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Total Quality defects	**0 - 5**	**> 5 - 10**	**> 10 - 20**	**> 20 - 40**	**> 40**
QUALITY CONDITION					
Decay	0	0	> 0 -1	> 1 - 3	> 3
Mold	0	0	> 0 -1	> 1 - 3	> 3
Seeding	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Spreading	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Wet Tips	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Soft Tips	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Feathering	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Flabbiness	0 - 10	> 10 - 25	> 25 - 50	> 50 - 75	> 75
Shriveling	0	> 0 - 5	> 5 - 10	> 10 - 20	> 20
Dry Butts	0 - 10	> 10 - 25	> 25 - 50	> 50 - 75	> 75
Freezing / Chilling Injury	0	> 0 - 5	> 5 - 10	> 10 - 20	> 20
Pitting	0 - 5	>5 - 10	>10 - 20	> 20 - 40	>40
Total Condition defects	**0 - 5**	**> 5 - 10**	**> 10 - 20**	**> 20 - 40**	**> 40**

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1. Defectos de Calidad

Undersize / Oversize (Diameter): Defect is considered when the diameter is less than or greater than the range determined for each gauge.



White butts: Lack of coloration at the base of the turions, it should be considered a defect when the white area exceeds 2 centimeters from the base.





Broken Tips / Puntas Rotas: A defect that must be considered when the tips of the turions are broken.





Too Long / Short Stalks: Turions that exceed the average length of the box should be considered when they hit the ceiling, as well as very short turions





Misshape / Deforme: Misshapen turions, are considered shoots that are noticeably out of shape.





Mechanical Damage / Daño Mecánico: It is identified by any type of visible damage to the turions, these can be split turions, abrasions on the epidermis or perforations.





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Poor Trimming / Mal Corte: It is considered a defect when the cut is not clean enough or is presented with an angle greater than 90 degrees.





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2. Condition defects

Decay / Pudrición: Asparagus have a strong odor in the affected turions, they are darker in color and the epidermis melts to the touch.




Seeding / Semillado: Seeds exceed the lower half of the tip of the turions.




Spreading / Esparcimiento: Bracts of the tips of the asparagus are not compact, showing a noticeable spread.





Wet Tips / Puntas Mojadas: The tips of the turions show excess moisture, it should be checked with the fingers, if when checking the state of the tip the fingers are wet is considered a defect.





Soft Tips / Puntas Blandas: It is considered a defect when the tip of the turion shows excessively soft bracts




Flabbiness / Flácido: Dehydrated turions that present a notable lack of turgor, each shoot should be considered as a defect that when bent presents enough flexibility so that the tip touches the stem.




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Shriveling / Deshidratación: It is considered as a defect those turions that show wrinkling due to dehydration, generally associated with flaccid shoots.




Dry Butts / Base Deshidratada: Dehydration present at the base of the turions, is characterized by the depression of the surface of the turions, in extreme cases the middle zone is split.




Freezing Damage / Daño por frío: Caused by overexposure of turions to low temperatures, it is characterized by a dark green appearance and no fresh appearance.





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